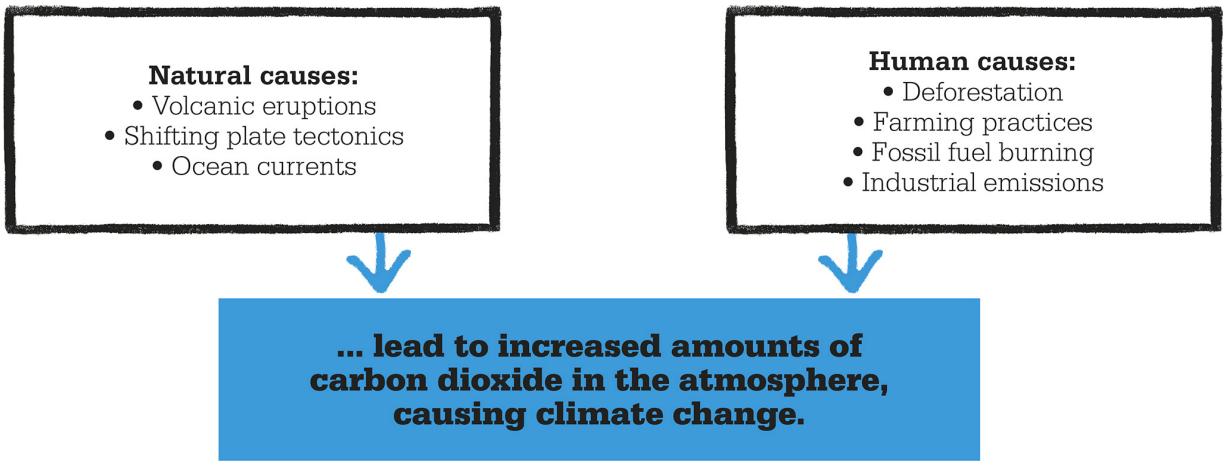


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Creation of the IPCC

In 1988, the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) was established in Geneva, Switzerland, by two United Nations organizations: UNEP and the World Meteorological Organization (WMO). Swedish meteorologist Bert Bolin—who was in the Advisory Group on Greenhouse Gases that the IPCC supplanted—was the panel's first chairman.

The IPCC was created to serve as a globally coordinated response to climate change linked to human activity. It issues reports based on scientific research in support of the main international treaty on climate change: the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC), which was signed at the Earth Summit in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, in 1992. The IPCC's work also involves issuing the Summary for Policymakers (SPM), which provides summaries of climate change research to governments around the world to help them understand the threats to humans and the environment as a result of climate change.